

tral argument for open source software has been that security is enhanced by more people looking at the available code. Another probable and important use for Google Code Search is that it allows developers to do searches for their own code and see where it is being used. A positive implication is that it may also help to combat plagiarism and software license use violations.

Google has a mechanism to tackle illegal postings and plagiarism. The moment it is notified of fraud, it initiates an inquiry, and if proven true, the entry is removed from the index.

2.5 Threat Perception

Google Code Search enables open source repositories to be mined with ease. As a result, security professionals across the globe have issued warning statements to developers. The reason is very simple—vulnerable programs / services can be easily targeted. As the search engine sifts through code with suitable modifications, it can be made to parse for flaws. Yet, the dangers are manifold. A simple query may spring many surprises. For example, one reviewer used “todo+security” as the search query and obtained many programs with unimplemented code properties.

The only thing that can be done for sure is to educate programmers on secure programming techniques to know what is dangerous and what is not. Frequent code reviews are a must, and finally, coding policies need to be enforced.

2.6 In Conclusion

What began as a service for Google programmers to search through internal company code is now available for a global audience. The promise it holds of alleviating the problem of finding and sharing code may usher in a new age of programming productivity and give a fresh boost to the open source movement.